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Entrepreneurial Survival Checklist

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Abraham of London • 2026-04-21

Why a Survival Checklist?

In theory, entrepreneurship is innovation, disruption and upside. In reality, it is often **cashflow stress, uncertainty and invisible pressure**.

This checklist is designed to help you **survive long enough to win** - without losing your integrity, your family or your mind.

2. Revenue Pipeline

- ☐ I can list my **top 10 current opportunities** and their likely close dates.
- ☐ I know **who** needs a call, follow-up or proposal this week.
- ☐ I am not building a product in isolation from real, paying customers.
- ☐ At least one block of my week is protected for **selling / business development**, not just admin.

Question to ask yourself weekly:

> *"If nothing new closed for 90 days, what would actually happen?"*

4. Legal & Compliance Basics

- ☐ My company registrations, filings and tax obligations are not being ignored.
- ☐ I know my next **critical filing date** (e.g. accounts, tax return).
- ☐ I have at least a **basic written agreement** with key customers and partners.

Chaos and confusion are expensive. Clarity is cheaper than litigation.

6. Decision Framework

Before major decisions (new hire, big spend, pivot), ask:

- ☐ What problem am I actually solving?
- ☐ What are my **best-case, base-case, worst-case** scenarios?
- ☐ What is the **irreversible downside** if this goes wrong?
- ☐ Who have I let challenge this decision?

If you cannot explain the decision on **one page**, you probably do not understand it yet.

7. Red / Amber / Green Self-Assessment

Take 5 minutes and label each area:

- Green:** under control, monitored
- Amber:** gaps, but manageable
- Red:** serious risk, needs immediate attention

Then choose **one red and one amber** to tackle this week. Survival is not magic; it is **consistent, honest prioritisation**.